

## FL-25-001339 ROMERO VS ROMERO

County: stanislaus

Division: Family Law

Department: 13

Hearing date: 2026-07-14

Motion: Petitioner's Request for Order re Spousal Support, etc.—HEARING REQUIRED, in part; DENIED, without prejudice, in part. The requests for child and spousal support are not eligible for tentative ruling and require a hearing. This is also true of the need-based request for attorney's fees and costs. However, while it also appears need-based, the Court elects to issue a tentative ruling as to the request for \$25,000.00 in "expert witness" professional fees. In that regard, Petitioner's declaration does not specify the expert witness sought to be retained, the scope of the retention and the reasonableness and necessity of doing so. Counsel for Petitioner did not submit a declaration on this point at all. As noted in Respondent's Responsive Declaration, there is a question as to whether one or more of the subject businesses is even a going concern and relevant to property division. Given that Petitioner did not seek to have the case designated as "complex" pursuant to Family Code section 2032(d), and the Court lacks sufficient evidence to make this finding at this time, the request is denied without prejudice. The case is relatively recent and the Court advises counsel to meet and confer in good faith with a view towards resolution and/or narrowing the disputed issues for trial. (Cal. Rules of Ct., rule 5.98(a).)

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